

END OF INTER CHAN 03
And then the people who had the information were asked to draw up the letter. Then he, Ilgner's deputy) sent the letter for me to sign it, and it was sent on to Keppler. Pressure? That was a very natural request. There was no pressure. I - -

"You have answered the question."

"It was information. We thought it was important in our own interests."

"Mr. Haeffliger, you have answered the question. I don't think you have to elaborate."

((3 SPACES))

Like Pollak; Wilhelm Keppler was more influential dead than alive. His diary disclosed that he had wished to have all the larger industries remain in Austrian hands, that he had been thinking about getting some general advice from Farben on how the Austrian chemical industries might collaborate with Farben. On the day after the Anschluss, Haeffliger called to remind him that Farben had "already been training Austrians for the past few years." Keppler brushed aside this hint, said that he was still open to advice, though he neither mentioned nor implied anything so extensive as a New Order. Then, on receiving Haeffliger's New Order letter, he had thrown up his hands and inquired sarcastically "whether the I. G. intended to swallow up the entire chemical industry of Austria."

Something wore ~~down~~ ^{KEPPLER} down. Perhaps a bribe, perhaps an appeal to pride. Or, perhaps all the preceding arguments sank in, and he saw that he might be the first link in dynamic chain of events. ^{PP} Before he even sought Farben's advice, Haeffliger had been looking toward the plants of Czechoslovakia. To the Commercial Committee, meeting during the week before the "NewOrder" reached Vienna, Haeffliger reported: "I took advantage of the opportunity to sound Keppler out on the attitude of the German authorities as to exerting influence on enterprises in Sudetan Czechoslovakia."

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